

KF3 Meeting Version of Teachings

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

At this early stage in the Karis Fellowships training cycle, we can add this understanding to our KF prayer: the Hebrew word for *pain* or *sorrow* is a word that also means *idol*. This alternative translation is particularly meaningful for us in KF as we learn to contend with the Idol Self. So, I am now going to pray this prayer incorporating what we have just learned.

“Examine me, O God, and reveal my motivations. Run experiments on me and discover my fearful thoughts. See if there is any hurtful or idolatrous way in me, and lead me in the ways of eternity.”

Take a deep breath.

0:01 OPENING

0:02 PRESENTING

0:07 KARIS CIRCULATION

0:08 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

0:09 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

Let’s take a little time to consider why we do mindfulness training. Most of our KF training teaches us to be motivated by principles, by our commitment to doing things God’s way, and by what we know to be true about ourselves. We have created an idol, however, and because we are caught up in its pride system, we are often motivated by emotional reactions that restore our pride and relieve our fear. Through training in mindfulness, we are able to step back from these reactions and make informed choices based on real evidence. We learn that we don’t have to run down misoriented paths, chased by our own fears. Rather, we can stand in the face of those fears and resist our old habitual patterns. We might feel the same desperation or compulsive need, but we don’t have to act on it. Mindfulness and meditation are invaluable tools that will help us make this change.

Let’s practice the **3-Minute Breathing Space**.¹

AWARENESS

Place your feet on the ground and lengthen your spine, or you may wish to sit cross-legged on the floor. Be kind to your body. If you are fatigued, prop yourself up with pillows. Close your eyes and take a few seconds to arrive at this moment in your life. *(Pause for 10 seconds)* Now, gently explore who you are and where you are. You might notice subtle sensations in your body, or you might recognize thoughts or feelings. Some of these may be unwanted. Experiment with simply observing and acknowledging what is there, without trying to cling to it, explain it, or push it away. Just observe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

GATHERING

Gently bring your full attention to your breath, observing each in-breath and each out-breath. You don't need to change your breathing. Where do you feel the breath most? In your nose . . . the back of your throat . . . your chest . . . your abdomen? *(Pause for 10 seconds)* Observe your breath circulating in and out, co-responding with the air around you. When your mind wanders, kindly guide it back to your breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

EXPANDING

Expand your awareness now to include not only your breathing but also a sense of yourself as a whole person. Observe your mind, body, and heart—the trinity of your entire self—as you breathe for one minute. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Close this time by gradually re-engaging with the world around you. Experiment with carrying some of this awareness with you as you move through the rest of the meeting.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this training?")

0:20 KARIS CONFESSION

0:21 TOOLBOX

Before we get started, I would like to remind you to check the website for the week's worksheets and teachings. Just click on **Meeting Guides and Teachings** under the **KF** tab. The **Meeting Version** is the version that is read in the meetings. The **Expanded Version** adds information and stories to the meeting notes. Also, during the week, Karis Fellowships sends out regular emails with portions of the **Expanded Version**. We call this gift the **KF Compass**. Please write to admin@karisfellowships.com if you would like to receive these emails.

If you miss a meeting, be sure to read the teaching notes. You can also hear a recording of the meeting through the playback number and participate with the group in the meditations and integrations. KF families and couples might like to listen to the meeting together. Members have experienced healing from just listening to the recordings.

If you select **Healing/Integration** under the **Toolbox** tab on the KF website, you will find the **Tapping Protocol**.² We will focus on this protocol for two lessons, so you might wish to print out a copy.

This is KF Confession 1:

We confess that we have worshipped and served an Idol Self that we have created.

During the next few weeks, we will look at this first Confession. Let's read it again in the first person singular: ***I** confess that **I** have worshipped and served an Idol Self that **I** have created. (Repeat)* By confessing this to the Lord, we acknowledge that we have violated the First Commandment: "Thou shalt have no other gods before Me."³ We understand what this means for us today because we have all studied the book *Neurosis and Human Growth*.⁴

Fear is not hard to spot in our lives. That's why we start looking at our fears very early in our KF training.

Some people might say that we should not think about negative things. In KF, we would say that we should think about true things if we want freedom. If we feel fear, then it is true that we feel fear, but we do not need to be afraid of our fear. This brings us to an important point: *We can acknowledge and look at our fear without fearing our fear. (Repeat)* Moreover, in looking, we learn to stop fearing. If we will not allow ourselves to think about our fear, we cannot look at it. If we cannot look at it, we cannot understand it. If we cannot understand it, we cannot find solutions.

Fear is so powerful in our lives that we often obey our fear rather than fearing and obeying God. We worship fear more than we worship God, for worship is really about allegiance and obedience. This brings us back to Nancy's original point: *If we want to stop obeying our fears, we must first be willing to look at them.*

When we are misoriented, we are in a constant state of fear, whether we recognize it or not. Our fears began with the basic anxiety of living in a world without the skills or support that we needed to survive. We tried to save ourselves from the tyranny of our fears by designing an Idol Self and adhering to its dictates. Our imagined ability to live up to the standard of these dictates then became a source of pride, but this only served to increase our fears because our pride was now invested in our achievements. Shame and inadequacy, our inglorious past, and our failure to fulfill our claims and shoulds hurt our bloated pride. We became afraid of our own self-condemnation; we became afraid of our own self-hate.

We will be able to manage our self-hate more easily if we can first calm our fear. So, during this coming week, try to identify the events that seem to trigger your fears. Make a list of these events and fears on your **Meeting Preparation Guide** under question two, the question about being messed-up. In KF training, we will apply the idea from First John of the *day of judgment*, which can be likened to a courtroom.⁵ In this courtroom of examination, it is your reactions to particular events that are sifted and weighed. Here, the truth about the quality of your faith and where you have placed your trust is revealed. This is a gift. You get to discover the level of your trustworthiness and the truth about your confidence in God. Like a scientific researcher, just step back and observe your reactions. Put on your white lab coat and capture the evidence of what is there. Pop a cork into the test tube of your fear and hold it up to the light.

As you begin this investigation, remember that fear reactions may not feel like fear. For your first research project, begin comparing your behavior and choices with those on the list **Love or Pride?** At the end of the day, look over the list and identify any situations in your day where love has not been your primary motivator. Jot down those events on your **Meeting Preparation Guide**. At this point in your training, think about this: *If it isn't love, it is fear.* If what you are doing is not love, it is fear.

Next week, we will learn how to tap. Tapping calms your body down when you are afraid. With a calmer body, you can mindfully observe your fears and make efforts not to obey them. You will choose an event that has revealed one of your fears, and you will learn how to deal with the fear by using the **Tapping Protocol**.⁶ To help yourself prepare for next week, you might watch [Alison's tapping and TAT videos](#) on YouTube. Alison is the co-founder of Karis Fellowships. She is also the creator of the KF website, which makes the gift of Karis Fellowships accessible to you.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Father, I am ready to face my fears. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?”)

0:30 SHARING

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

In this lesson, we will begin looking at a familiar passage in the letter from James, which you can find toward the end of the New Testament, just after Hebrews. This is Nancy’s translation of **James 1:1–4**, with a little paraphrase for clarity.

¹James, a bondservant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, to the twelve tribes who are dispersed abroad: Greetings. ²Guide yourselves into all joy, my siblings, when you fall into and are surrounded by all kinds of experiments, ³knowing that these experiments examine what you trust and act upon. They also grow your ability to remain under examination in future experiments that will further explore your ever-expanding potential. ⁴Give this growing ability of endurance a chance to accomplish its purpose, which is to make you a mature and complete person, lacking nothing, fully equipped for your joy and mission.

Take a deep breath.

James, or Jacob in Hebrew, is writing to the Jewish Christians who were forced by persecution to scatter throughout the Roman Empire. These people knew suffering and fear, and yet James tells them this: “Guide yourselves into all joy when you fall into all kinds of experiments.”⁷

When interpreting this passage, some translators use the words *consider it all joy*, but the Greek word for *consider* can also mean to *lead* or *guide oneself*. You can guide yourself into all joy when you fall into various tests. These various tests, or experiments, are your days of judgment; they are showing you what you are made of. What’s more, this passage teaches that you have an active choice in your experiments. You can choose to be joyful and bold as you discover what is real about yourself and about your world.

Look at your KF Confessions again. We hope that you will post them somewhere to help you keep them in mind. Notice that through the Confessions you are regularly committing yourself to an authentic, real, true, and honest life. If you are in Karis Fellowships, you are working toward knowing the truth about yourself, doing true things, and speaking the truth. You will also be learning to step out of the misorientation that hinders you and harms your life. Exploring your misorientation may feel like a depressing task, but take heart! You won’t just be knowing, you will also be growing. Guide yourself into that joy.

Now what are these experiments that James is talking about? The Greek word that is often translated as *trial* has to do with tests or experiments that reveal what is real, what is there. When we are interested in the True Self, which Karen Horney calls the real self, we are interested in what is real about ourselves right now.⁸ We are like researchers. We are not judging an outcome as good or bad; we are eagerly seeking what is real and true. We also want to know what is possible. When we approach a scientific experiment *without* preconceived ideas about the outcome, we are excited about what we are going to discover. The same principle applies when we examine our lives. Conversely, if we approach an experiment *with* preconceived ideas about what we want to see, what would be good or bad, and what would support our pride, we come to the experiment with apprehension. We are fixated on an outcome

that our pride feels it must have. We are focusing on the future, and that takes us out of the real present. We are not joyful or creative about the process. Rather, we are anxious, and our observation is distorted by our efforts to save the Idol's life. We may even avoid acknowledging what we see, even if it's beneficial, because it doesn't fit our preconceived illusions.

Our True Self, however, is eager for truth to be revealed in our lives because it is motivated by love—and love, as Paul teaches us, rejoices in the truth.⁹ Here is an interesting observation about the word *experience*. The spelling of the words *experience* and *experiment* is almost the same. That's because they are derived from the same root word.¹⁰ All of your experiences are experiments with reality and can be interpreted as opportunities, or days of judgment, that show you the truth about who you are right now; they reveal your actual self. Experiences measure your progress as you develop the potential of your real glory. Free from the judgments that support your pride, you can rejoice in what you learn. You can rejoice because these discoveries are essential for your growth. *In order to get where you want to go, you have to know where you are right now. (Repeat)*

Our prayer might go something like this:

Loving Father, teach me to rejoice in my experiments. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?")

1:10 INTEGRATION

During the integration, you might jot down some notes on the back of your **Meeting Preparation Guide** or in your KF journal. Sip some purified water and assume a mindfulness posture. Breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider a fear that reveals the truth about your faith. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

The FAITH Process

Feelings

As you *consider a fear that reveals the truth about your faith*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* You can learn to recognize and honor your feelings without allowing them to master you. Observe with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Awareness without judgment

Graciously allow whatever you are experiencing to just be. As you breathe, hold your experience up to the light. Observe whatever tension might be there as you *consider a fear that reveals the truth about your faith. (Pause)* Feelings and passing thoughts are not right or wrong; they just are. Give yourself permission now to explore them without judgment, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Breathe, and bring your attention to your body. Notice what it is doing when you *consider this fear that reveals the truth about your faith*. What sensations are there? *(Pause)* Your body is always talking to you.

You may not understand its language right now, but you can observe. For example, you might recognize what panic or judgment feels like in your body. You might feel relief or curiosity. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider this fear that reveals the truth about your faith*. Does that feel comfortable, scary, or vague and slippery? Just observe. *(Pause)* Do you judge your fear as good or evil? *(Pause)* What are your reasons? What story do you want to tell? *(Pause)* Is this experience a regular pattern in your life? *(Pause)* Observe your responses as just information, and breathe with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Heal

God created us to have all of these feelings, and for thousands of years human beings have been feeling like you do when they have experienced fears that reveal the truth about their faith. You are not alone in your feelings. You are a human creature. *(Pause)* Feelings are just chemical reactions in your body bringing you information. With training, you can choose what you will do with that information. *(Pause)* When a fear or judgment signals you through the body, you can focus on your body and your breath rather than getting caught up in a story and reacting. As you consider this fear, breathe and have compassion for yourself. Help your body process with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

(Optional) Continue to breathe while I check for further integration.

Pause. Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank you for this time together of healing and training. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and to the truth about our faith. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?")

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

¹ Zindel Segal, J. Mark G. Williams and John D. Teasdale, *Mindfulness-Based Cognitive Therapy for Depression* (New York: Guilford Press, 2013), 208. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

² Dr. Roger Callahan, "TFT Stress Buster Tapping Class-Learn to Use TFT Tapping," Callahan Techniques, accessed April 24, 2016, www.rogercallahan.com/learn-to-tap.php. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

³ Exod. 20:3.

⁴ Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991).

⁵ 1 John 4:17.

⁶ Dr. Roger Callahan, "TFT Stress Buster Tapping Class-Learn to Use TFT Tapping," Callahan Techniques, accessed April 24, 2016, www.rogercallahan.com/learn-to-tap.php. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

⁷ James 1:2.

⁸ Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991).

⁹ 1 Cor. 13:6.

¹⁰ www.sloww.co/experience-experiment-etymology/.